

Chapter 59: Mental Health of Adolescents in Relation to Home Environment, Emotional Intelligence and Self-Concept in Thodupuzha Taluk, Kerala State

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Abstract

Emotional Intelligence enhances the talent of artful leader in utilizing people and in capturing their hearts. Emotional Intelligence also helps to cope with stressful situations. Emotionally intelligent individual leads a happy and peaceful life. They express the characteristics like adoptable and resilient mind, cheerful and optimistic outlook, well-regulated instincts and habits, insight into one's own conduct, good tempered, socially adoptable and having a definite philosophy of life and realistic imagination. Therefore, the development of emotions is extremely important for a harmonious development of the personality. Therefore, the researcher is intended to study the mental health of higher secondary students in relation with home environment, emotional intelligence and self-concept in Thodupuzha district, Kerala state and give suggestions to improve the mental health status of higher secondary students. Out of the total sample of 800 higher secondary students 400 higher secondary students were selected from the schools situated in rural areas and 400 higher secondary students were selected from the schools situated in urban areas. They were selected through stratified proportionate random sampling method. A simple random sample should be taken from each stratum by adopting a random number table method. It is observed from the study that 27 percent of the respondents had a high level of emotional intelligence, 38.5 percent of the respondents had a moderate and 27 percent of the respondents had a low level of emotional intelligence. Further, 24.5 percent of the respondents had a high level of mental health, half (50 percent) of the respondents had a moderate level, whereas 25.5 percent of the respondents had a low level of mental health. However, 25 percent of the respondents had a low level of overall level of self-concept, 51 percent of the respondents had a moderate level and 24 percent of the respondents had a high level of overall level of self-concept. The researcher suggests that emotional intelligence being a significant factor in future success should be more emphasized in educational situations. Development of healthy social relationships and well balanced personality is possible through the knowledge of Emotional Intelligence. School environment should be encouraging for adolescents. They should be counseled for their career ahead as teenage is a stage of choosing next upcoming career. This counseling may help a child to get serious for their future. Parents should allow children to go for excursion so as they may be become more expressive and responsible.

Keywords: Mental Health, Home Environment, Emotional Intelligence and Self-concept

1. Introduction

The academic performance of any student cannot be separated from the home environment in which the child lives healthy home environment offers emotional security to a child (Deb et al., 2015). Education has one of its basic tasks as to train young people to become useful members of the society. This training begins at home in the informal way (Agarwal, 1995). The home of the child is the first place he enters as

he is born into the world by his or her parents. Children are motivated to work on activities and learn new information and skills when their environments are rich in interesting activities that arouse their curiosity and offer moderate challenges (Nihira et al., 1980). The same can be said about home environment, unfortunately there is much variability in motivational influences in homes, some homes have many activities that stimulate children thinking as well as computer, books, puzzles and parents who may be heavily interested in their children cognitive development and spent time with them on learning (Bernard, 1970). Much of the variability in the relation between family income and children's intellectual development comes from the family provision of a stimulating home environment (Kaur, 2007). Children intellectual development is most strongly influenced by the home environment during infancy and early childhood. As children mature, schools and peers also begin to play a role in their intellectual socialization (Bernard, 1970). There is much evidence supporting the hypothesis that the quality of a child's early learning in the home environment relate positively to the development of intelligent and reading skills and parental involvement in schooling also predict achievement (Mangala and Satyaparkasha, 2009). Various homes factors have been shown to be important, mother's responsiveness, discipline style and involvement with the child, organization of the environment, availability appropriate of learning materials, opportunities for daily stimulation (Misra, 1984). Parents, who provide a warm, responsive and supporting environment, encourage exploration, stimulate curiosity and provide play and learning materials accelerate their children's intellectual development. Within the home environment we must examine both the roles of mothers and fathers because differentiate parent behaviour has often been implicated as a variable affecting children's development (Muola, 2010). Some of the potential parental behaviour that can influence children motivational beliefs are: attributions for the child's school performance, perception of the task difficulty of school work, value for school work and expectation and confidence in children's abilities (Paul, 2015; Arkoff, 1968 and Vasuki and Raj, 2015).

The home environment provides the foundation for learning and is an element of the student life that can affect grades (Gnamavel and Diane 2017). According to experts the mother's educational level had the single most important impact on a young child's academic performance. Educated parents will always believe that it is important to help a child with his or her homework and revise the school work that the child had done but this is the opposite if a child is from a poor home environment to a large extent he or she is deprived of the opportunities and he or she struggle with the teaching and learning process (Kumari and Chamundeswari 2013 and Joseph, 2015). Similarly, the emotional aspect of home environment is also playing a great role on children's academic achievement. The emotional atmosphere in the home may exercise a great influence on the child. If, there is a cold care-less attitude, irregularly and evasion of discipline, the child may display such undesirable characteristics as dishonesty, aggression and lack of punctuality (Kumari and Chamundeswari 2013). The quarrels, dissatisfaction and instability of the home atmosphere may disturb child's emotional equilibrium and it may also have a deleterious influence on the child in that he also adopts these attitudes in imitations of his parents (Gayen and Kumar 2018). Emotional stress, insecurity and anxiety are factors which certainly affect the child's school work, they are a drain on his energy and they reduce concentration and prevent him from applying to the full his intellectual powers (Gnamavel and Diane 2017). Thus, a child from a well to do home with a good cultural background may have high ability and a high intelligence test score, but because of an unsettling home environment may a child perform relatively poor on his academic achievement (Manju and Mollykutty 2013). This study will produce some important result that has implication for education. This essence of the researcher findings, will facilities our understanding of the home environment factors,

especially emotional and social, which are thought to be responsible for a mature and balanced personality of an adolescents that significantly contributes in one's success in life. It will fulfill the research gap in this area and create a comprehensive study circle for the students/research scholars keeping in pace with the growing importance of effect of home environment on academic achievement of the adolescents. Most families in our society seem not to give adequate attention to the education of their children. It appears some of the parents have erroneous notion about the performance of their children, they do not know and seem to fulfill their role of guidance and encouragement in the child's performance in schools. Some people also have the notion that the mass failure or success in schools could be traced back to the teachers and the school authorities (Boruah and Hazarika 2015). While other people see socio-economic status of the family as an influence to the child's emotional intelligence and mental health. Family environments, mental health and emotional intelligence are much more important than school environment in influencing adolescent aspirations (Santhosh Kumar, 2011). Therefore, the researcher is intended to study the mental health of higher secondary students in relation with home environment, emotional intelligence and self-concept in Thodupuzha taluk, Kerala state and give suggestions to improve the mental health status of higher secondary students.

2. Materials and Methods

2.1. Objectives of the Study

- 3) To find the emotional intelligence among the higher secondary students.
- 4) To study the self-concept among the higher secondary students.
- 5) To examine the mental health status in relation to emotional intelligence and self-concept among the higher secondary students.

2.2. Research Design

For the present study, it was necessary for the researcher to highlight the problems /issues encountered by adolescents which affects their mental health and home environment. Thus, in order to achieve all the above mentioned objectives, researcher has adopted descriptive research design for the present study.

2.3. Universe

The universe of the present study includes all the higher secondary students who are studying in the jurisdiction of Thodupuzha Taluk of Kerala State. The sample of the present study was drawn from 20 senior secondary schools of government, government aided and privately managed schools in Thodupuzha Taluk, Kerala state. The universe consists of 5402 higher secondary students are studying in 20 senior secondary government, government aided and privately managed schools in Thodupuzha Taluk, Kerala state.

2.4. Sampling Technique

Out of the universe 4003 adolescents are studying in rural based schools which include 2059 boys and 1944 girls and 1399 adolescents are studying in urban based schools which include 686 boys and 713 girls. For the present study 20 boys' and 20 girls' higher secondary students were selected from each senior secondary school in Thodupuzha Taluk, Kerala State. From this sample frame the researcher selected 800 adolescents for data collection. Out of the total sample of 800 adolescents 640 adolescents were selected from the schools situated in rural areas and 160 adolescents were selected from the schools situated in urban areas. Out of the 640 rural adolescents 320 girls and 320 boys were selected. Similarly, out of 160 urban adolescents 80 girls and 80 girls were selected. The sample for the study was selected randomly to ensure that every unit of the population gets equal chance of being selected. The researcher

ensured that discretions of the researcher should not get involved in the selection of the sample from the population. They were selected through stratified proportionate random sampling method. A simple random sample should be taken from each stratum by adopting a random number table method.

3. Major Findings

Table No: 1: Distribution of the respondents according to their perception towards various dimensions of Emotional Intelligence

S. No.	Various dimensions of Emotional Intelligence	No. of Respondents (n = 800)	Percentage
1.	Social Awareness		
	Low	252	31.5
	Moderate	364	45.5
	High	184	23.0
2.	Managing Emotions		
	Low	236	29.5
	Moderate	420	52.5
	High	144	18.0
3.	Motivating Oneself		
	Low	236	29.5
	Moderate	424	53.0
	High	140	17.5
4.	Empathy		
	Low	292	36.5
	Moderate	340	42.5
	High	168	21.0
5.	Social Skills		
	Low	260	32.5
	Moderate	364	45.5
	High	176	22.0
6.	Overall level of Emotional Intelligence		
	Low	276	34.5

	Moderate	308	38.5
	High	216	27.0

Table 1 crystal clear that nearly half of the respondents have a moderate level of various dimensions of emotional intelligence such as social awareness (45.5 percent), managing emotions (52.5 percent), motivating oneself (53 percent), empathy (42.5 percent) and social skills (45.5 percent). However, one-thirds of the respondents have a low emotional intelligence and one-fifths of the respondents have a high level of emotional intelligence. Further, 27 percent of the respondents' overall level of emotional intelligence is high, 38.5 percent of the respondents' overall level of emotional intelligence is moderate and 27 percent of the respondents' overall level of emotional intelligence is high. The research observed that a person's feelings cannot be observed directly by others but they can be inferred from his overt behaviour. To exhibit emotions is very easy but doing it at the right time, at the right place with the right person and to the right degree is difficult. The management of emotions has given rise to the most talked about term 'Emotional Intelligence'. Emotional intelligence involves the ability to perceive accurately, appraise and express emotions, the ability to access and generate feelings when they facilitate thoughts, the ability to understand emotions and emotional knowledge and intellectual growth.

Table No: 2 Distribution of the respondents according to their perception towards various dimensions of Self-concept

S. No.	Various dimensions of Self-Concept	No. of Respondents (n = 800)	Percentage
1.	Physical		
	Low	244	30.5
	Moderate	404	50.5
	High	152	19.0
2.	Social		
	Low	220	27.5
	Moderate	444	55.5
	High	136	17.0
3.	Temperamental		
	Low	264	33.0
	Moderate	396	49.5
	High	140	17.5
4.	Educational		

	Low	204	25.5
	Moderate	344	43.0
	High	252	31.5
5.	Moral		
	Low	276	34.5
	Moderate	284	35.5
	High	240	30.0
6.	Intellectual		
	Low	252	31.5
	Moderate	392	49.0
	High	156	19.5
7.	Overall level of Self-concept		
	Low	200	25.0
	Moderate	408	51.0
	High	192	24.0

Table 2 shows that half of the respondents have a moderate level of self-concept in various dimensions such as physical (50.5 percent), social (55.5 percent), temperamental (49.5 percent), educational (43 percent), moral (35.5 percent), intellectual (49 percent). However, one-thirds of the respondents have a low level of perception towards self-concept and one-fifths of the respondents have a high level of perception towards various dimensions of self-concept. Further, 25 percent of the respondents have a low level of overall level of self-concept, 51 percent of the respondents have a moderate level of overall level of self-concept and 24 percent of the respondents have a high level of overall level of self-concept. The researcher concluded that Self-concept as our important cognitive factor that affects human behaviour has been widely recognized today. Self-concept refers to the sum of the person's attitudes and knowledge towards himself and evaluation of his achievement. It is the individual's perception of himself as a person, which includes his abilities, appearance, performances in his job and other phases of daily living.

Table No: 3: ‘Z’ Test between the Class Studying of the respondents and perception towards various dimensions of Self-concept

S. No	Class Studying	Sample size (n=800)	$\bar{X}$	S.D.	Statistical Inference
1.	Physical				Z = 1.521
	11th Std.	428	24.2336	3.80947	0.129>0.05

	12th Std.	372	23.8172	3.92091	Not Significant
2.	Social				Z = 1.502
	11th Std.	428	29.0467	3.74449	0.133>0.05
	12th Std.	372	28.6559	3.58341	Not Significant
3.	Temperamental				Z = 2.658
	11th Std.	428	28.1308	3.85227	0.008<0.01
	12th Std.	372	27.3548	4.40447	Highly Significant
4.	Educational				Z = 0.459
	11th Std.	428	29.0093	4.56336	0.647>0.05
	12th Std.	372	28.8602	4.61240	Not Significant
5.	Moral				Z = 0.950
	11th Std.	428	29.6075	3.83197	0.342>0.05
	12th Std.	372	29.3548	3.65536	Not Significant
6.	Intellectual				Z = 1.210
	11th Std.	428	26.6262	3.86790	0.227>0.05
	12th Std.	372	26.2796	4.23148	Not Significant
7.	Overall level of Self-concept				Z = 1.953
	11th Std.	428	166.6542	16.42190	0.051<0.05
	12th Std.	372	164.3226	17.31096	Significant

H_a = There is a significant difference between the class studying of the respondents and their perception towards overall level of self-concept.

H_0 = There is no significant difference between the class studying of the respondents and their perception towards overall level of self-concept.

It is deduced from the table 3 that there is a significant different between the class studying of the respondents and their perception towards a dimension of self-concept such as temperamental. However, there is no significant difference between the class studying of the respondents and their perception towards various dimensions of self-concept such as physical, social, educational, moral and intellectual. Further, there is a highly significant difference between the class studying of the respondents and their perception towards overall level of self-concept ($Z=1.953$, $0.051<0.05$). It is manifested from the table that class studying of the respondents has influence on the level of perception towards self-concept. It is found from the study that the mean score ($\bar{X}=17.31096$) indicates respondents who have studying 12th Std. have a high level of perception towards self-concept.

Statistical Inference:

‘Z’ test was used to test the above hypothesis and it was found that there is a significant difference between the class studying of the respondents and their perception towards overall level of

self-concept ($Z=1.953$, $0.051<0.05$). It is seen from table that the calculated value of the 'Z' test is more than the table value at the 1 percent and 5 percent level of significance.

Hence Research Hypothesis is accepted.

Table No: 4 Association between the Age of the respondents and perception towards various dimensions of Emotional Intelligence

S. No	Age	Various dimensions of Emotional Intelligence			Statistical Inference
		Low	Moderate	High	
1.	Social Awareness	n=252	n=364	n=184	$\chi^2 = 45.431$ df = 6 $0.000<0.01$ Highly Significant Contingency Coefficient=0.232
	15 Years	44	40	28	
	16 Years	116	144	116	
	17 Years	72	144	36	
	18 Years	20	36	4	
2.	Managing Emotions	n=236	n=420	n=144	$\chi^2 = 14.955$ df = 6 $0.021<0.05$ Significant Contingency Coefficient=0.135
	15 Years	32	52	28	
	16 Years	120	184	72	
	17 Years	64	148	40	
	18 Years	20	36	4	
3.	Motivating Oneself	n=236	n=424	n=140	$\chi^2 = 7.274$ df = 6 $0.296>0.05$ Not Significant
	15 Years	28	64	20	
	16 Years	116	184	76	
	17 Years	76	140	36	
	18 Years	16	36	8	
4.	Empathy	n=292	n=340	n=168	$\chi^2 = 58.099$ df = 6 $0.000<0.01$ Highly Significant Contingency Coefficient=0.260
	15 Years	24	64	24	
	16 Years	148	120	108	
	17 Years	92	124	36	
	18 Years	28	32	0	
5.	Social Skills	n=260	n=364	n=176	$\chi^2 = 29.648$

	15 Years	32	48	32	df = 6 0.000<0.01 Highly Significant Contingency Coefficient=0.189
	16 Years	116	156	104	
	17 Years	84	132	36	
	18 Years	28	28	4	
6.	Overall level of Emotional Intelligence	n=276	n=308	n=216	$\chi^2 = 34.855$ df = 6 0.000<0.01 Highly Significant Contingency Coefficient=0.204
	15 Years	36	44	32	
	16 Years	128	116	132	
	17 Years	88	120	44	
	18 Years	24	28	8	

Hypothesis 04

H_a = There is a significant association between the age of the respondents and their perception towards overall level of emotional intelligence.

H_0 = There is no significant association between the age of the respondents and their perception towards overall level of emotional intelligence.

It is proved from the table 4 that there is a highly significant association between the age of the respondents and their perception towards various dimensions of emotional intelligence such as social awareness, managing emotions, empathy and social skills. However, there is no significant association between the age of the respondents and their perception towards a dimension of emotional intelligence such as motivating oneself. Further, there is a highly significant association between the age of the respondents and their perception towards overall level of emotional intelligence ($\chi^2=34.855$, $0.000<0.01$). It is noticed from the table that age of the respondents has influence on the perception towards various dimensions of emotional intelligence. It is indicates from the statistical analysis that the respondents who are in the age of 16 years have a high level of emotional intelligence in terms of social awareness, managing emotions, empathy and social skills. The contingency coefficient has explained that the strength of association between the age of the respondents and their overall level of emotional intelligence is at 20 percent. It is elucidated from the statistical analysis that the age of the respondents is strongly associated with their perception towards various dimensions of emotional intelligence such as social awareness (23 percent), managing emotions (13 percent), empathy (26 percent) and social skills (18 percent).

Statistical Inference:

‘ χ^2 ’ test was used to test the above hypothesis and it was found that there is a significant association between the age of the respondents and their perception towards overall level of emotional intelligence ($\chi^2 = 34.855$, $0.000 < 0.01$). It is seen from table that the calculated value of the ‘ χ^2 ’ test is more than the table value at the 1 percent level of significance.

Hence Research Hypothesis is accepted.

4. Recommendations

- The development of psychological aspects like Mental Health in higher secondary students is very crucial for the formation of various skills and concepts. The adolescents at this stage usually imitate and tend to be alone and take somebody as their role model.
- Oftentimes when their mood is low, they should have a hard time imagining what it would be like if the problem were no longer present. Envisioning a world where the problem no longer exists and taking steps to resolve it can be a very effective way of improving mood and changing the external circumstances that are triggering the difficulties.
- Meditation helps people slow down their minds, which is beneficial to those who have problems with concentration. In addition, meditation is associated with decreased stress, better sleep patterns, and a more positive mood. Similarly, other relaxation exercises like deep breathing, progressive muscle relaxation, and guided visualizations can help increase clarity and focus.
- Feelings of low self-esteem and hopelessness can be a big part of having a mental illness. Volunteering for a cause they believe in can help these students feel good about themselves as they help other people—as well as connect with peers who share the same interests. This is a great way for these students to improve their mood and develop a sense of purpose.
- Teachers should know the areas where the students lack mental health and try to give better conditions for proper development in every sphere of life. School should provide facilities to differently abled students for better mental health.
- Parents and administrators should provide congenial environment in the school in order to boost the self-concept of adolescent which in turn will enhance the level of self-concept of adolescents. For this, various curricular and co-curricular activities must be organized in the school. Principals should see that adolescents should not be scolded and should not feel any inadequacy of educational environment in school. If possible some guidance service should be provided in the school so that mental health of the adolescents may not be disturbed in any way.

5. Conclusion

The contemporary world is facing and surfacing unimaginable and unending changes that are flooding into various aspects of human life. Education, with no exception is also undergoing innumerable changes in the society. These changes are posing a great confusion both to people and pupil. The secondary school level is an important stage in the academic life of any individual. During this stage the students come under the influence of various psychological aspects which contribute a lot in the success and shape of their future. Noticing this conspicuous reason, efforts should be made to meet the requirements of the students and provide proper direction. There is increasing evidence that education is a powerful

instrument to improve all types of well-being of a nation. It is also an established fact that the degree of education and the technical competence but not the amount of nature and natural reserves determine the economic welfare of any country. So progress of a country can be measured with the quality and quantity of its schools. There has been a rapid change of vast magnitude in all spheres during the recent past. Technological changes, industrial changes, occupational changes, and revolution of rising expectations from all walks of people with all these social changes, it is important that the educational system should change itself to the needs of the day.

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